

Part I – Definitions (2pts each)

Provide a clear and philosophically precise definition (2–4 sentences each).

1. **Grounding**
 2. **Indiscernibility of Identicals**
 3. **Actual Infinite**
 4. **Impression (Humean sense)**
 5. **Presentism**
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Part II – Short Answer

Answer 6 of the following 8.

Each answer should be 5–8 well-constructed sentences.

Each is worth 15 points (90 pts total).

Clarity and precision matter more than length.

1. A-Theory vs. B-Theory of Time

Explain the difference between the A-series and B-series theories of time.

- What distinguishes tensed from tenseless facts?
- What role does temporal becoming play in each view?
- Why is the A-theory often described as dynamic and the B-theory as static?

Be sure to state clearly what each theory claims about the metaphysical status of past, present, and future events.

2. Presentism and Modern Physics

Why does Presentism appear to conflict with contemporary physics?

- What does Presentism claim about what exists?

- Why does relativity theory challenge the idea of an absolute present?
- What is the problem of frame-dependence?

Explain the tension clearly, even if you ultimately think it can be resolved.

3. Hume on Impressions and Causation

Explain Hume's notion of an impression.

- What is an idea for Hume?
- Why does Hume search for an impression corresponding to necessary connection?
- Why does he conclude that no such impression exists?

State briefly what Hume thinks the idea of necessity actually consists in.

4. Leibniz's Principle of Sufficient Reason

Explain Leibniz's understanding of the Principle of Sufficient Reason (PSR).

- What does it mean to say that nothing happens without a sufficient reason?
- How does Leibniz connect PSR to his theory of truth (predicate-in-subject)?
- Why does PSR push Leibniz toward a necessary being?

Your answer should reflect Leibniz's metaphysical, not merely causal, conception of explanation.

5. The Bennett–van Inwagen Argument

Explain the Bennett–van Inwagen argument that the Principle of Sufficient Reason entails necessitarianism.

- What is the "conjunction of all contingent facts"?
- Why can its explanation not be contingent?
- How does this lead to the conclusion that all facts are necessary?

Keep the structure of the argument clear and concise.

6. Hilbert's Hotel

Explain Hilbert's Hotel and how it is used in arguments about the impossibility of an actual infinite.

- Why can new guests be accommodated even when the hotel is full?
- Why does subtraction in yield counterintuitive results?
- What is the philosophical lesson Craig and others draw from this example?

Focus on the metaphysical point, not just the story.

7. PSR in the Kalam Cosmological Argument

Explain how Craig and Moreland use ideas related to the Principle of Sufficient Reason in the Kalam cosmological argument.

- How does the intuition that things do not come from nothing function in the argument?
- If the universe has a beginning, why does that beginning also demand an explanation?
- How does this connect to the claim that the universe must have a cause?

Clarify how this differs from a purely Leibnizian cosmological argument.

8. Grounding vs. Causation

Explain the difference between grounding and causation.

- What does it mean to say that one fact obtains "in virtue of" another?
- Why is grounding typically taken to be non-causal?
- How does grounding differ in formal features (e.g., symmetry, temporality) from causation?

Briefly explain why this distinction matters for debates about PSR.